

COOKIES POLICY

Effective Date: 1 March 2026

Website: www.worldpublicationsawards.com

Organization: World Publications Awards (“WPA”, “we”, “us”, “our”)

1. What Are Cookies?

Cookies are small text files placed on your device (computer, tablet, smartphone) when you visit a website. They help websites function properly, improve user experience, and collect information about usage and performance.

This Cookies Policy explains how World Publications Awards uses cookies.

2. Why We Use Cookies

We use cookies to:

- Enable secure voting functionality
- Prevent fraudulent or automated voting
- Improve website performance
- Process payments
- Analyse traffic and user behaviour
- Remember user preferences
- Protect platform integrity

Because WPA operates as both an awards platform and a crowdfunding voting system, certain cookies are necessary for fraud prevention and payment security.

3. Types of Cookies We Use

3.1 Strictly Necessary Cookies

These cookies are essential for the website to function.

They may include:

- Session cookies
- Security authentication cookies
- Fraud detection cookies
- Load balancing cookies

Without these cookies, voting and payment processing may not work properly.

These cookies do not require user consent under most laws because they are necessary for the functioning of the service.

3.2 Payment Processing Cookies

When you make a \$3 vote payment, third-party payment providers (such as PayPal or Stripe) may place cookies on your device.

These cookies may:

- Authenticate transactions
- Prevent fraud
- Detect suspicious activity
- Process cross-border payments

WPA does not control these cookies. Their use is governed by the payment provider's own privacy and cookies policies.

3.3 Analytics Cookies

We may use analytics tools (e.g., Google Analytics or similar) to:

- Track page visits
- Measure traffic sources

- Analyse user interaction
- Improve site performance

Analytics cookies may collect:

- IP address (anonymised where possible)
- Device type
- Browser type
- Time spent on pages
- Referring website

These cookies help us understand global participation and ensure system stability during peak voting periods.

3.4 Performance & Functional Cookies

These cookies:

- Remember display preferences
 - Improve loading speed
 - Ensure voting pages render correctly
 - Enhance user experience
-

3.5 Fraud Prevention Cookies

Because WPA involves paid public voting and monetary distribution:

We may use cookies to:

- Detect multiple votes from suspicious sources
- Identify bot activity
- Monitor abnormal traffic spikes
- Protect nominee fairness

These cookies are essential for maintaining the integrity of the Awards.

4. Third-Party Cookies

Third parties may place cookies through our website, including:

- Payment processors
- Social media platforms (when viewing nominee links)
- Embedded external content
- Analytics providers

WPA does not control how third parties use cookies.

Users should review the privacy and cookie policies of those third-party services.

5. How Long Cookies Are Stored

Cookies may be:

- **Session cookies** – deleted when you close your browser
- **Persistent cookies** – remain on your device for a set period

Retention periods vary depending on the type and purpose of the cookie.

6. Managing Cookies

You may:

- Disable cookies through your browser settings
- Delete existing cookies
- Set alerts before cookies are stored

However, disabling cookies may:

- Prevent you from completing payments
- Block voting functionality
- Interfere with fraud detection systems
- Reduce website performance

WPA is not responsible for platform malfunction resulting from disabled cookies.

7. Consent (Where Required by Law)

In jurisdictions such as the European Union, users may be presented with a cookie consent banner allowing them to:

- Accept all cookies
- Reject non-essential cookies
- Customize cookie preferences

Continued use of the website after accepting cookies indicates consent.

8. International Users

Because WPA operates globally, cookies may process data across international borders.

We take reasonable steps to ensure data protection standards consistent with:

- GDPR principles (where applicable)
 - International best practices
-

9. Data Collected Through Cookies

Cookies may collect:

- IP address
- Browser type
- Device information
- Geographic region
- Voting interaction patterns
- Transaction timestamps

Cookies do not collect full credit card numbers.

10. Updates to This Policy

We may update this Cookies Policy to reflect:

- Legal requirements
- Technology changes
- Security improvements
- New payment providers

Updated versions will be published with a revised effective date.

11. Contact Us

World Publications Awards

Website: www.worldpublicationsawards.com

Email: hello@worldpublicationsawards.com

Operating Jurisdiction: Commonwealth of Australia